

# Nielsen Norman Group

# Heuristic Evaluation

# Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.



# Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator  
: Date:  
Product:  
Task:

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## Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

### Issues

- During training in-progress, the app shows a circular timer but does not indicate how many exercises remain out of the total (e.g., "Exercise 2 of 5").
- When syncing training data, the progress bar displays "65%" but does not show an estimated time remaining for the sync operation.
- The bottom navigation bar highlights the active tab in volt-green, but there is no transition animation when switching between tabs, making the state change feel abrupt.

### Recommendations

- Add a step indicator (e.g., "Exercise 2/5") alongside the circular timer on the Training In Progress screen to give users a clear sense of their position in the workout.
- Include an estimated time remaining label below the sync progress bar (e.g., "Syncing... 65% — ~10 seconds remaining").
- Add a subtle tab-switch animation (e.g., underline slide or icon scale) to provide smoother visual feedback when navigating between tabs.

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## Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the

### Issues

- The term "RPE" (Rate of Perceived Exertion) on the Training Completed screen may not be immediately familiar to casual or younger users who are not trained athletes.
- The "Surface Container" and "On Surface Variant" terminology used in the design system documentation is technical and internal — though not user-facing, it could cause confusion if exposed in developer handoff.

### Recommendations

- Add a brief tooltip or inline label explaining RPE, such as "RPE — How hard did this feel? (1 = Easy, 10 = Maximum Effort)" directly on the Training Completed screen.
- Ensure that all design-system-specific terminology remains internal and is never exposed in the user interface. User-facing labels should use plain language like "effort rating" instead of "RPE scale."

terminology used in the design?

- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

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## User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

### Issues

- Once a training session is started (Training In Progress screen), there is no clearly visible "Pause" or "End Session Early" button — the user appears locked into the timer flow.
- The confirmation dialog for "Delete Training Session" provides Cancel and Delete buttons, but there is no undo option after the deletion is confirmed.
- On the Login screen, if a user starts typing in the wrong field (e.g., email in the password field), there is no quick "Clear" button to reset the input.

### Recommendations

- Add a visible "Pause" button and a "Stop / End Early" option on the Training In Progress screen, allowing users to exit the session without waiting for the timer to complete.
- After a destructive action like session deletion, show a temporary undo toast notification (e.g., "Session deleted. Undo?") for 5–8 seconds before permanently removing the data.
- Add a small "x" clear icon inside each input field on the Login/Sign Up screen to allow quick field reset.

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## Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used

### Issues

- The primary CTA button style is mostly consistent (violet-green fill with dark text), but on the Welcome Screen the "Get Started" button appears slightly different in border radius compared to the "Start Training" button on the Speed Detail screen.
- The bottom navigation uses icon-only representation on some screens, while labels are visible on others — this inconsistency may confuse users about which tab they are on.

### Recommendations

- Standardize the border-radius of all primary CTA buttons across every screen to a single value (e.g., 0.375rem or fully rounded) to ensure pixel-perfect visual consistency.
- Ensure that the bottom navigation bar always shows both the icon and the text label on every screen, regardless of screen height or content length.

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consistently throughout the design?

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## Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

### Issues

- On the Login screen, the "Enter Training Facility" button appears clickable even when the email and password fields are empty, which could result in unnecessary error messages.
- The Training Calendar allows users to tap on any date, but there is no confirmation step before scheduling a session — an accidental tap could create an unintended session.

### Recommendations

- Disable the login button (greyed out) until both email and password fields contain valid input. Use real-time inline validation to show feedback as the user types (e.g., "Please enter a valid email").
- Add a confirmation step or a short "Schedule session?" prompt when a user taps a date on the Training Calendar, preventing accidental session creation.

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## Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that

### Issues

- The Drill Library displays drill cards with names and difficulty levels, but does not show a preview image or icon for each drill type, requiring users to recall what each drill entails based on the name alone.
- The Training Completed screen shows session statistics (time, exercises, calories), but does not provide a link back to the specific drills performed — users must remember which exercises they just completed.

### Recommendations

- Add a small icon or thumbnail image to each drill card in the Drill Library that visually represents the drill type (e.g., a running figure for "Sprint Intervals," a ball for "Ball Control"), aiding recognition.
- Include a collapsible "Session Details" section on the Training Completed screen that lists the specific exercises performed, allowing users to review their workout without relying on memory.

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users do not have to memorize  
it?

- Does the design offer  
help in-context?



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## Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

### Issues

- There are no keyboard shortcuts or gesture-based shortcuts for frequent actions like starting a favorite drill or accessing the most recent session.
- The app does not provide a "Quick Start" or "Repeat Last Session" feature — returning users must navigate through the full Training Categories → Drill Detail → Start flow each time.

### Recommendations

- Add a "Quick Start" button on the Player Dashboard that allows returning users to instantly repeat their last training session with one tap.
- Implement a "Favorites" or "Pinned Drills" feature that allows experienced users to save their most-used drills for rapid access from the Dashboard.

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## Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

### Issues

- The Player Dashboard contains four quick-action cards, an upcoming session card, AND a weekly progress bar — on smaller mobile screens, this may feel slightly crowded.
- The Match Preparation screen displays both a checklist and a full team readiness section with multiple player rows, which creates a dense information layout.

### Recommendations

- Consider collapsing the "Upcoming Session" and "Weekly Progress" sections into a single summary card on the Dashboard, or allowing users to swipe between them to reduce visual density.
- On the Match Preparation screen, consider using a collapsible/accordion pattern for the team readiness section, showing only a summary by default and expanding on tap.

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## Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

### Issues

- The error toast notification ("Failed to sync data. Please check your connection.") is displayed briefly but does not provide a retry button — users must manually trigger the sync again.
- On the Login Error state, the error message is shown as a red banner, but it does not specify whether the error is due to an incorrect email or incorrect password.

### Recommendations

- Add a "Retry" button directly on the error toast notification so users can immediately attempt the failed action again without navigating elsewhere.
- Improve the Login error message to be more specific: instead of a generic "Login failed," specify "Incorrect password" or "No account found with this email" to help users diagnose and fix the issue quickly.

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## Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

### Issues

- The app does not include an onboarding tutorial or walkthrough for first-time users — new players must figure out the app structure on their own.
- There is no contextual help or FAQ section accessible from within the app. The Settings screen includes account management but no "Help" or "Support" option.

### Recommendations

- Add a brief onboarding flow (3–4 screens) that appears on first launch, highlighting key features: browsing drills, starting training, and tracking progress.
- Add a "Help & FAQ" section in the Settings / Profile screen that provides answers to common questions and a way to contact support if needed.